



Head Start Program Settings Guide

A step-by-step reference for completing the Head Start Program settings in MenuMaker — what each field means, what it affects, and how to fill it in correctly.

Settings >  Head Start Program

Who should complete this section: the Program Director or Office Manager.
Fill it in once during initial setup, then update only when information changes (new dietitian, schedule change, grant renewal).

Note: changing the Program Type takes effect immediately after saving and updates the navigation for all users of the system.

1 Program Type

This is the master switch for the entire application. It controls which sidebar sections, reports, and forms are available to your team. All existing data — menus, recipes, children — is preserved when you switch.

OPTION	WHEN TO CHOOSE	SECTIONS ADDED TO SIDEBAR
CACFP	Your center participates in the Child and Adult Care Food Program and submits monthly reimbursement claims	Claim Report, CACFP Reports
Head Start	Your center is funded by a Head Start or Early Head Start grant and operates under federal standards 45 CFR Part 1302	Family Engagement, HS Reports; RD approval workflow in Menu Planner

What changes when you select Head Start:

- Menu Planner shows a status bar: Draft → Submitted for RD Review → RD Approved → Published
- Special Diet forms gain CF/HS-27 fields (substitution type, review date, Health Manager sign-off)
- Recipes gain a Product Documents panel (upload CN Labels, Standardized Recipe cards, Product Specs)
- HS Reports provides PIR nutrition section data ready to enter into HSES

2 Program Schedule

 DAILY HOURS

The total number of hours children are enrolled in the program each day. Head Start Performance Standards set different meal nutrition requirements based on this value:

PROGRAM LENGTH	MEAL NUTRITION REQUIREMENT
Less than 6 hours	Meals must provide 1⁄3 to 1⁄2 of children's daily nutritional needs
6 hours or more	Meals must provide 1⁄2 to 2⁄3 of children's daily nutritional needs

Example: 6.5 for a program running 7:00 AM – 1:30 PM

The app displays a live hint below the field as soon as you type a value — you do not need to memorize the threshold.



START TIME / END TIME

The actual opening and closing time of your program each day. Use 24-hour HH:MM format. These times appear in reports and documentation to confirm the length of the program day.

Start Time: 07:00 **End Time:** 13:30



FISCAL YEAR START MONTH

The month your grant-funded fiscal year begins. This controls the reporting period displayed in HS Reports → PIR Data.

Default is October — the federal fiscal year in the U.S. begins October 1. If your grant starts in a different month, check your Notice of Award from HHS.

3 Registered Dietitian (RD)

Under **45 CFR 1302.44(b)**, all Head Start menus must be planned or approved by a licensed nutrition professional. The information in this section appears in the Menu Planner approval workflow and is printed on menus distributed to families.

Name

Full name of the dietitian who approves menus. Recorded in the database when **Approve Menu (RD)** is clicked in the Menu Planner, and printed on menu handouts sent to families.

Example: Sarah Johnson

Credentials

Professional credential abbreviations, comma-separated. Displayed next to the dietitian's name on reports and menu printouts to confirm their qualifications.

Common: RD, LDN RD, CDN, MS RD, LD

Email

The dietitian's professional email address. Used to identify the approver in the menu workflow. In a future release, this address will receive automatic notifications when a menu is submitted for review.

Example: s.johnson@nutritionservices.com

Grant Number

Your Head Start grant number from the Notice of Award issued by HHS. Included in PIR reports and all official nutrition documentation. You can find it on the first page of your grant agreement.

Example: 90CI5432/01 06CH010123

4 Health Manager

The Health Services Manager is responsible for reviewing and authorizing special dietary accommodations. Their name appears on CF/HS-27 forms in the Form Submissions section as the sign-off authority.

Name

Full name of the Health Services Manager. Displayed in Form Submissions → Special Diet / CF-HS27 under the *Health Manager Sign-Off* field for each accommodation on file.

Example: Maria Gonzalez

Email

Professional email of the Health Manager. Used for notifications when new special diet forms are submitted and require review.

Enrollment Capacity

The maximum number of children your program is licensed to serve. Used in HS Reports → PIR Data as the denominator when calculating the percentage of enrolled children with documented dietary needs.

Example: 120

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Saving Your Changes

All four sections — Program Type, Schedule, Registered Dietitian, and Health Manager — are saved together with a single click of **Save Changes** at the bottom of the page.

- Click **Save Changes** — a green “Saved” confirmation appears when successful
- The sidebar navigation updates **automatically** after saving — no page reload needed
- If a red error message appears, check your internet connection and try again
- You can return to this page at any time to update individual fields — changes take effect immediately

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Quick Reference — All Fields

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER	WHERE IT APPEARS IN THE APP
Program Type	CACFP or Head Start	Controls sidebar navigation and available modules for all users
Daily Hours	Decimal number, e.g. 6.5	Live nutrition-standard hint; program documentation
Start / End Time	HH:MM format, e.g. 07:00	Reports and program-length documentation
Fiscal Year Start Month	Month your grant year begins (usually October)	Reporting period in HS Reports → PIR Data
RD Name	Full name of the dietitian	Recorded on menu approval; printed on family menu handouts
RD Credentials	Comma-separated abbreviations: RD, LDN	Reports and menu printouts
RD Email	Dietitian's professional email	Approval workflow identification; future notifications
Grant Number	From Notice of Award, e.g. 90CI5432/01	PIR reporting and official nutrition documentation
Health Manager Name	Full name of the Health Services Manager	Sign-off field on CF/HS-27 special diet forms
Health Manager Email	Health Manager's professional email	Notifications for new special diet form submissions

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER	WHERE IT APPEARS IN THE APP
Enrollment Capacity	Licensed max enrollment, e.g. 120	Denominator for coverage percentages in PIR Data

Need help? Contact your system administrator or email playacademyusa@gmail.com. When describing an issue, please include the field name and the value you are trying to save.